General rule – Weapon Mastery · "Equipment" chapter of SRD 5.2.1

A **Mastery property** is a special trait of a weapon (Graze, Cleave, Push, etc.). To use it, you need the **Weapon Mastery class feature** (Barbarian, Fighter, Paladin, Ranger, Rogue) **and must have chosen** that weapon.

You can use the mastery of **each chosen weapon** when you wield it. Chosen weapons change after a Long Rest.

🎲 Quick summary:

1. You need the **class** feature and must have **chosen** the weapon.
2. The mastery applies to attacks with that weapon.
3. Each mastery has its own conditions (hit, miss, etc.).
4. You change chosen weapons after a **Long Rest**.

⚠ Change from 2014

New in 2024: these effects didn't exist in 2014. They give each weapon its own style.

⚠ Flaw in the rule and fixes Table rule

The SRD doesn't list masteries per weapon on this sheet; check the weapon table. Fix: keep the list handy at the table.

💡 Narrative option: Table rule

The DM can describe the effect (the blow pushes, trips) to make the mastery memorable.

Step 1 – Check access:

Does your class grant Weapon Mastery? How many weapons can you choose?

Step 2 – Choose weapons:

Choose melee or ranged weapons you are normally proficient with.

Step 3 – Attack:

Roll the attack with the chosen weapon. Its mastery applies if conditions are met.

Step 4 – Apply the effect:

Push, Graze, Slow, etc.: see the table on the next page.

Step 5 – Change:

After a Long Rest, you can choose other weapons.

Example: Brann, a Fighter, chooses the greataxe (Cleave). He hits a goblin: he also attacks a second enemy within 5 ft of the first.

Mastery	Effect
Cleave	After a melee hit, attack a 2nd enemy within 5 ft of the first (once per turn).
Graze	On a miss, damage equal to the ability modifier.
Nick	Extra attack with the Light weapon, as part of the Attack action.
Push	Push 10 ft (Large or smaller) in a straight line.
Sap	Disadvantage on the target's next attack.
Slow	Speed reduced by 10 ft until the start of your next turn.
Topple	Constitution save; on a fail, Prone.
Vex	Advantage on your next attack against that target.

⚠ Common questions:

Who can use masteries?

Barbarian, Fighter, Paladin, Ranger, Rogue (with the class feature).

Do I need to hit?

Depends: Graze works on a miss, the others on a hit.

How many masteries at once?

One per chosen weapon; several weapons, several masteries.

Do masteries stack?

Yes if they come from different weapons.

Can I change weapons?

Yes, after a Long Rest.

Does a magic weapon keep the mastery?

Yes, if it's of the chosen type.

Improvised weapons?

No: they have no mastery.

⚠ Debate points and table options: Table rule

Chosen weapons

The number of chosen weapons depends on class and level. **Option**: follow the class table.

Ranged mastery

Do ranged weapons have masteries? **Option**: yes, as in the SRD.

Nick and Cleave

Both on one weapon? **Option**: yes if chosen twice.

Balance

Many features to remember. **Option**: one sheet per player.

⚠ Rule clarifications (answers found on the web, reworded):

Cleave

Once per turn only, and the second enemy must be in range.

Graze

The damage can only grow by raising the modifier.

Push

Only affects creatures of Large size or smaller.

Slow

Doesn't stack: several hits, one reduction.

These points remain open to discussion: your feedback is welcome to refine this sheet.

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